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**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**
**MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION APRIL 2026**
**SECOND SEMESTER**
**Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG2MDCENG102 - FUNDAMENTALS OF ADVERTISING AND PUBLIC RELATIONS**

**Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes** **Maximum Marks: 50**

**Scheme of Valuation**

## Part A - MCQ
**Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark**

1. b). La Presse [K] / [CO1]
2. a). Empowering slogans [U] / [CO1]
3. b). Reactive Advertising [K] / [CO2]
4. b). During commutes [K] / [CO2]
5. b). A convincing copy and an appealing design [K] / [CO3]

**(1x5=5)**

## Part B - SHORT ANSWER
**Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks**

6. **Interactivity** (1994): The first banner ad (AT&T) shifted advertising from static images to clickable, interactive content. **Democratisation** (2000): Google AdWords introduced the pay-per-click model, making advertising affordable and measurable for businesses of all sizes. **Personalisation**: Amazon and social media pioneered targeting based on individual browsing history and specific user behaviours. **Smart Integration**: Modern advertising uses AI and smartphone location data for hyper-personalised, real-time communication. [U]/[CO1]
7. **Genericisation** is the process by which a brand name becomes so dominant and synonymous with a product or service that it is used as a common, generic term. It occurs through consistently reinforcing a product's unique strengths and market-leading qualities, which creates the perception of absolute expertise in the consumer's mind. Eg. Google's focus on speed and reliability made it the leader in search. As a result, the phrase "Google it" has become a generic verb for searching online, regardless of the search engine used. [U] / [CO1]
8. The AIDCA formula helps advertisers by providing a psychological roadmap that guides consumers from initial awareness to a final purchase. It structures a persuasive campaign through Attention, Interest, Desire, Conviction, and Action. By following these sequential stages, advertisers can effectively bridge the gap between a consumer's practical needs and their subconscious desires. [U] / [CO1]
9. Flyers serve as high-impact, event-specific tools designed for quick distribution and immediate attention. They structure a campaign through concise single-page formats, bold headlines, and lightweight, cost-effective materials. By fusing striking visual design with persuasive copy, advertisers efficiently capture and convert broad audiences in high-traffic environments. *(Note: Award marks for any creative, relevant tagline that effectively promotes the discount within the 5-7 word limit.)* [A] / [CO2]
10. **Trust Words** (Psychological Security**):** Words like *"Guaranteed"* or *"Authentic"* build brand authority and reduce purchase anxiety. Their impact is to create long-term

confidence and reliability, which is essential for high-value decisions like financial investments. **Scarcity Words** (Psychological Urgency): Terms like *"Limited"* or *"Last chance"* trigger the "fear of missing out" (FOMO). Instead of security, they create immediate pressure to bypass logical hesitation, as seen in Amazon's "Only 2 left" alerts. [U] / [CO2]

11. ASCI guidelines for Privacy and Data Protection:
    **Legal Compliance:** Advertisements must respect consumer privacy and strictly adhere to all applicable data protection laws. **Explicit Consent**: Personal information cannot be used for advertising purposes unless the consumer has given clear and explicit permission. **Transparency**: Targeted advertising must be honest and transparent regarding how consumer data is collected and utilized. [U] / [CO2]
12. Johnson & Johnson recalled 31 million bottles ($100 million cost) and issued immediate public warnings. Acknowledged the issue quickly and provided regular updates through trusted media channels. Worked closely with law enforcement and established new industry standards with tamper-resistant packaging. Thus, they transformed a tragedy into a benchmark for corporate responsibility by proving that ethical PR prioritises public welfare over short-term financial loss. [U] / [CO3]
13. It ensures the most critical journalistic information (Who, What, When, Where, Why, and How) is presented at the very beginning to capture attention immediately. It logically organizes the narrative by placing crucial evidence, quotes, and background details in "The Body" only after the main hook is established. It leaves extra, related context for "The Tail," allowing reporters to instantly grasp the core story while still having access to additional details if needed. [U] / [CO3]
14. **Allocate resources strategically to manage the campaign effectively. Evaluate the campaign's effectiveness using metrics like customer sentiment analysis, sales changes, or website traffic. Conduct mid-term appraisals for long-term programs to ensure objectives are being met.** [U] / [CO3]

**(5x6=30)**

## Part C - ESSAY
**Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks**

15. Direct Headlines function by delivering straightforward, unambiguous statements that immediately communicate a key benefit or offer. They avoid wordplay and are highly effective for driving immediate action during sales or promotions. They typically include specific numbers, prices, or clear promises. Eg*:* "50% Off on All Laptops for Students". Indirect Headlines function by using intrigue to create a "knowledge gap" that draws the reader in. They are effective at engaging readers intellectually or emotionally using clever wordplay, questions, or provocative statements that pique curiosity without giving away the full message. They are particularly effective when you want to engage readers emotionally or intellectually. Eg*:* "Your Morning Routine is About to Change Forever". [U] / [CO1]

16. **i. Gender Stereotyping** – Advertisements often portray women as homemakers, caregivers and self-sacrificing mothers, while men are shown as dominant, career-oriented and emotionally distant. Such portrayals reinforce traditional gender roles and unrealistic expectations. *Eg:* Detergent ads showing women doing household chores; male grooming ads linking masculinity with success and dominance. **ii. Cultural and Ethnic Stereotyping**– Advertisements reduce minority communities and ethnic groups to simplified clichés, stereotypical professions, accents or behaviours, often reinforcing

prejudice and social bias. *Eg:* Nivea's "Re-Civilize Yourself" campaign and Intel's "Maximize Computing Performance" ad were criticized for racial insensitivity. **iii. Age Stereotyping** – Advertisements create a generation gap by portraying older adults as dependent, technologically confused, and resistant to change, while younger people are shown as impulsive, superficial, and overly obsessed with social media. *Eg:* Digital payment ads depicting seniors confused by apps like PhonePe or Google Pay**. iv. Body Image Stereotyping** – Advertising promotes narrow standards of beauty by associating attractiveness, confidence, and success with thinness, muscularity, or fair skin. Such portrayals negatively affect self-esteem and body image. *Eg:* Fair & Lovely advertisements promoting fair skin as the key to success; fitness ads equating muscularity with masculinity. [K] / [CO2]

**17.** Public Relations (PR) evolved from ancient rulers in Egypt, Babylon, and Greece using communication to influence public opinion, to organised persuasion during the American Revolution through slogans like "No Taxation without Representation." The Industrial Revolution and the growth of newspapers and mass media made public opinion important for businesses and governments. Ivy Lee developed modern PR through honest communication and crisis management, while Edward Bernays used psychology and mass media to shape consumer behaviour and public opinion. In the 20th century, PR expanded into government campaigns, corporate communication and later digital media, social media, and reputation management. American PR practices strongly influenced global PR by introducing professional communication methods, crisis management, image building, and scientific audience persuasion techniques used worldwide today. [U] / [CO3]

**(15x1=15)**